

JAVA

Competitive Programming — Complete Reference

*Helper methods for Arrays · Strings · HashMap · Stack · Queue · PriorityQueue · Bit tricks —
and everything in between*

Prepared for TCS NQT & general competitive-programming use

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*T.C = Time Complexity, S.C = Space Complexity. * = amortized / average case — worst case can differ (e.g. hash collisions, dynamic array resizing).*

1. Arrays (java.util.Arrays)

Method	T.C	S.C	Use
Arrays.sort(arr) $O(n \log n)$	$O(\log n)$		Sorts the array ascending, in place. Example: [3,1,2] → [1,2,3]. $O(n \log n)$.
Arrays.sort(arr, from, to) $O(n \log n)$	$O(\log n)$		Sorts only the sub-range [from, to) (to is exclusive), leaving the rest untouched.
Arrays.sort(arr, cmp) $O(n \log n)$	$O(n)$		Sorts using a custom Comparator. Only works on Object[] (e.g. Integer[]) or 2D arrays — NOT plain int[]/double[], since primitives have no Comparator overload.
Arrays.fill(arr, val) $O(n)$	$O(1)$		Overwrites every element with val. Example: Arrays.fill(arr, -1) → all -1s.
Arrays.fill(arr, from, to, val) $O(n)$	$O(1)$		Overwrites only indices [from, to) with val; rest of the array is untouched.
Arrays.copyOf(arr, newLen) $O(n)$	$O(n)$		Returns a new array of length newLen, copying old values in and padding extra slots with 0/null.
Arrays.copyOfRange(arr, from, to) $O(n)$	$O(n)$		Returns a new array containing just the sub-range [from, to) of the original.
Arrays.equals(a, b) $O(n)$	$O(1)$		Checks two 1D arrays have the same length and equal elements at every index (unlike a==b, which just compares references).
Arrays.deepEquals(a, b) $O(n)$	$O(n)$		Like Arrays.equals but recurses into nested arrays — use for 2D/3D arrays.
Arrays.toString(arr) $O(n)$	$O(n)$		Builds a readable String like "[1, 2, 3]" for a 1D array — use for printing/debugging.
Arrays.deepToString(arr) $O(n)$	$O(n)$		Like Arrays.toString but recurses into nested arrays — use for printing 2D/3D arrays.
Arrays.binarySearch(arr, key) $O(\log n)$	$O(1)$		Finds key's index in an ALREADY-SORTED array in $O(\log n)$. Returns a negative number if key is absent — sort first or results are undefined.
Arrays.asList(arr) $O(1)$	$O(1)$		Wraps an Object[] (e.g. Integer[], String[]) as a fixed-size List view backed by the same array — you can set() elements but NOT add()/remove(). Does not work directly on int[].
Arrays.stream(arr).sum().max().min() $O(n)$	$O(1)$		Converts an int[] to an IntStream to quickly get its sum, max, or min without writing a loop.

Reverse-sort an int[] (no direct method exists):

```
Integer[] boxed = Arrays.stream(arr).boxed().toArray(Integer[]::new);
Arrays.sort(boxed, Collections.reverseOrder());
```

💡 int[] cannot be sorted in reverse directly — box it to Integer[] first.

2. ArrayList (java.util.ArrayList)

Method	T.C	S.C	Use
add(x)	$O(1)^*$	$O(1)$	Appends x to the end of the list. $O(1)$ on average (amortized).
add(index, x)	$O(n)$	$O(1)$	Inserts x at position index, shifting later elements right by one. $O(n)$ because of the shift.
get(index)	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Returns the element at position index. $O(1)$ — ArrayList is backed by an array.
set(index, x)	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Replaces the element at position index with x and returns the old value.
remove(index)	$O(n)$	$O(1)$	Removes the element at position index (by position!) and shifts later elements left. $O(n)$.
remove(Object o)	$O(n)$	$O(1)$	Removes the first element equal to o (by value!), not by index. Tip: for Integer lists, remove((Integer) 5) removes the value 5, while remove(5) removes the element at index 5.
size()	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Returns how many elements are currently in the list (note: size(), not length like arrays).
contains(x)	$O(n)$	$O(1)$	Checks whether x is present anywhere in the list by scanning it. $O(n)$.
indexOf(x)	$O(n)$	$O(1)$	Returns the index of the first occurrence of x, or -1 if it isn't in the list.
isEmpty()	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Returns true if the list has zero elements — shorthand for size() == 0.
clear()	$O(n)$	$O(1)$	Removes every element, leaving the list empty (size() becomes 0).
Collections.sort(list)	$O(n \log n)$	$O(n)$	Sorts ascending using natural order. Example: Collections.sort(list) turns [5,2,8] into [2,5,8]. $O(n \log n)$.
Collections.sort(list, cmp)	$O(n \log n)$	$O(n)$	Sorts using a custom Comparator you provide. Example: Collections.sort(list, (a, b) -> b - a) sorts descending.
Collections.reverse(list)	$O(n)$	$O(1)$	Reverse in place
Collections.max/min(list)	$O(n)$	$O(1)$	Extremes
Collections.frequency(list, x)	$O(n)$	$O(1)$	Count occurrences
list.toArray(new Integer[0])	$O(n)$	$O(n)$	Copies the list's elements into a new Integer[] array of the right size.

3. String & StringBuilder

String is immutable — every modification creates a new object. Use StringBuilder inside loops.

Method	T.C	S.C	Use
s.length()	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Returns the number of characters in the string.
s.charAt(i)	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Returns the single character at index i (0-based). Throws an exception if i is out of range.
s.substring(a,b)	$O(n)$	$O(n)$	Returns the characters from index a up to (but not including) index b.
s.indexOf(ch/str)	$O(n)$	$O(1)$	Returns the index of the first occurrence of the character/substring, or -1 if not found.
s.lastIndexOf(ch/str)	$O(n)$	$O(1)$	Like indexOf but searches from the end, returning the last occurrence's index.
s.split(regex)	$O(n)$	$O(n)$	Splits the string on the given regex pattern and returns the pieces as a String[].
s.toCharArray()	$O(n)$	$O(n)$	Copies the string's characters into a new char[] so you can index/modify them directly.
s.equals(t) / equalsIgnoreCase(t)	$O(n)$	$O(1)$	Compares actual text content (equalsIgnoreCase ignores case). Always use this instead of == for strings, since == compares object references, not content.
s.compareTo(t)	$O(n)$	$O(1)$	Compares two strings alphabetically: negative if s < t, 0 if equal, positive if s > t.
s.trim() / s.strip()	$O(n)$	$O(n)$	Removes leading/trailing whitespace. strip() (Java 11+) also handles Unicode whitespace that trim() misses.
s.toUpperCase()/toLowerCase()	$O(n)$	$O(n)$	Returns a new string with all letters converted to upper/lower case (original string is unchanged, since Strings are immutable).
s.replace(old,new)	$O(n)$	$O(n)$	Returns a new string with every occurrence of old replaced by new.
s.contains(sub)	$O(n-m)$	$O(1)$	Returns true if sub appears anywhere inside the string.
s.startsWith()/endsWith()	$O(n)$	$O(1)$	Checks whether the string begins or ends with the given prefix/suffix.
String.valueOf(x)	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Converts almost any type (int, char, boolean, object, etc.) into its String representation.
String.join(",", list)	$O(n)$	$O(n)$	Joins a list/array of strings into one string, separated by the given delimiter — e.g. joins ["a","b"] into "a,b".
sb.append(x)	$O(1)^*$	$O(1)$	Adds x to the end of the StringBuilder's buffer in $O(1)$ amortized time — the efficient alternative to s = s + x.
sb.insert(i,x)	$O(n)$	$O(1)$	Inserts x into the buffer at position i, shifting later characters right.

Method	T.C	S.C	Use
sb.deleteCharAt(i)	$O(n)$	$O(1)$	Removes the single character at position i from the buffer.
sb.reverse()	$O(n)$	$O(1)$	Reverses the buffer's characters in place.
sb.setCharAt(i,ch)	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Overwrites the character at position i with ch.
sb.toString()	$O(n)$	$O(n)$	Converts the buffer's contents into an immutable String (call this when you're done building).

🔗 Never do $s = s + x$ inside a loop ($O(n^2)$ total). Always use `StringBuilder`.

4. HashMap / TreeMap / LinkedHashMap

Method	T.C	S.C	Use
map.put(k,v)	$O(1)^*$	$O(1)$	Inserts key k with value v, or overwrites v if k is already present.
map.get(k)	$O(1)^*$	$O(1)$	Returns the value mapped to k, or null if k isn't in the map.
map.getDefault(k,def)	$O(1)^*$	$O(1)$	Like get(k), but returns def instead of null when k is missing — avoids a manual null check.
map.containsKey(k)	$O(1)^*$	$O(1)$	Returns true if the map has an entry for key k.
map.remove(k)	$O(1)^*$	$O(1)$	Deletes the entry for key k (if present) and returns its old value.
map.putIfAbsent(k,v)	$O(1)^*$	$O(1)$	Inserts $k \rightarrow v$ only if k isn't already in the map; otherwise leaves the existing value untouched.
map.merge(k,v,(o,n) $\rightarrow$ o+n)	$O(1)^*$	$O(1)$	If k is absent, inserts $k \rightarrow v$. If k is present, combines the old value (o) and new value (n) with the given function — the standard idiom for building a frequency map.
map.compute(k,(key,val) $\rightarrow$ val+1)	$O(1)^*$	$O(1)$	Recomputes the value for key using a function you supply, based on the current value (val may be null if absent).
map.keySet() / .values() / .entrySet()	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Returns a view for iterating just the keys, just the values, or key-value pairs (Map.Entry) together.
map.size()	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Returns the number of key-value entries in the map.
TreeMap: firstKey()/lastKey()	$O(\log n)$	$O(1)$	Returns the smallest/largest key currently in the TreeMap (keys are kept sorted automatically).

Method	T.C	S.C	Use
TreeMap: ceilingKey(k)/floorKey(k) $O(\log n)$ $O(1)$			Returns the smallest key $\geq k$ (ceiling) or largest key $\leq k$ (floor), or null if none exists.
TreeMap: higherKey(k)/lowerKey(k) $O(\log n)$ $O(1)$			Like ceiling/floor but strict: smallest key $> k$, or largest key $< k$.
TreeMap: pollFirstEntry()/pollLastEntry() $O(\log n)$ $O(1)$			Removes and returns the entry with the smallest/largest key.

Frequency counter idiom:

```
map.merge(x, 1, Integer::sum); // increment count of x
```

5. HashSet / TreeSet

Method	T.C	S.C	Use
set.add(x) $O(1)^*$ $O(1)$			Inserts x if it's not already present; does nothing (no error) if it's a duplicate.
set.contains(x) $O(1)^*$ $O(1)$			Checks membership in average $O(1)$ time (HashSet) — much faster than scanning a list.
set.remove(x) $O(1)^*$ $O(1)$			Removes x from the set if present.
set.retainAll(other) $O(n)$ $O(1)$			Keeps only the elements also present in other — computes the set intersection, in place.
set.removeAll(other) $O(n)$ $O(1)$			Removes every element that's also in other — computes the set difference, in place.
set.addAll(other) $O(m)$ $O(1)$			Adds every element of other into this set — computes the set union, in place.
TreeSet: first()/last() $O(\log n)$ $O(1)$			Returns the smallest/largest element (TreeSet keeps elements sorted automatically).
TreeSet: ceiling(x)/floor(x) $O(\log n)$ $O(1)$			Returns the smallest element $\geq x$ (ceiling) or largest element $\leq x$ (floor).
TreeSet: higher(x)/lower(x) $O(\log n)$ $O(1)$			Like ceiling/floor but strict: smallest element $> x$, or largest element $< x$.
TreeSet: pollFirst()/pollLast() $O(\log n)$ $O(1)$			Removes and returns the smallest/largest element.

6. Stack (use ArrayDeque, not legacy Stack)

Method	T.C	S.C	Use
stack.push(x)	$O(1)^*$	$O(1)$	Adds x to the top of the stack (LIFO — last in, first out).
stack.pop()	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Removes and returns the top element. Throws if the stack is empty.
stack.peek()	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Returns the top element without removing it.
stack.isEmpty()	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Returns true if the stack has no elements.

Declaration:

```
Deque<Integer> stack = new ArrayDeque<>();
```

7. Queue / Deque (java.util.ArrayDeque)

Deque can act as Queue, Stack, or double-ended queue. Prefer ArrayDeque over LinkedList.

Method	T.C	S.C	Use
dq.offer(x) / offerLast(x)	$O(1)^*$	$O(1)$	Adds x to the back of the deque — the standard way to enqueue for FIFO use.
dq.offerFirst(x)	$O(1)^*$	$O(1)$	Adds x to the front of the deque.
dq.poll() / pollFirst()	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Removes and returns the front element, or null (not an exception) if the deque is empty.
dq.pollLast()	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Removes and returns the back element, or null if empty.
dq.peek() / peekFirst()	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Returns the front element without removing it (null if empty).
dq.peekLast()	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Returns the back element without removing it (null if empty).
dq.isEmpty() / size()	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Checks whether the deque is empty, or returns how many elements it holds.

🔗 Sliding window maximum: keep a `Deque<Integer>` of indices, values monotonic decreasing.

8. PriorityQueue (Min-Heap by default)

Method	T.C	S.C	Use
<code>new PriorityQueue<>()</code>	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Creates a min-heap: <code>poll()</code> always returns the smallest element first, using natural ordering.
<code>new PriorityQueue<>(Collections.reverseOrder())</code>	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Creates a max-heap: <code>poll()</code> always returns the largest element first.
<code>new PriorityQueue<>((a,b)->a[0]-b[0])</code>	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Creates a heap with a custom ordering rule — here, e.g. <code>int[]</code> pairs are ordered by their first element ascending.
<code>pq.offer(x) / add(x)</code>	$O(\log n)$	$O(1)$	Inserts <code>x</code> into the heap, maintaining heap order. $O(\log n)$.
<code>pq.poll()</code>	$O(\log n)$	$O(1)$	Removes and returns the top (min or max, depending on setup) element. $O(\log n)$.
<code>pq.peek()</code>	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Returns the top element without removing it. $O(1)$.
<code>pq.isEmpty() / size()</code>	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Checks whether the heap is empty, or returns how many elements it holds.

💡 Iterating a `PriorityQueue` does NOT give sorted order — only repeated `poll()` does.

9. Math & Integer/Long utilities

Method	T.C	S.C	Use
<code>Math.max(a,b) / min(a,b)</code>	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Returns the larger/smaller of two values.
<code>Math.abs(x)</code>	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Returns the absolute (non-negative) value of <code>x</code> .
<code>Math.pow(base,exp)</code>	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Returns <code>base</code> raised to the power <code>exp</code> , as a double (not an int).
<code>Math.sqrt(x)</code>	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Returns the square root of <code>x</code> , as a double.
<code>Math.ceil(x) / floor(x)</code>	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Rounds <code>x</code> up (ceil) or down (floor) to the nearest whole number, returned as a double.
<code>Math.round(x)</code>	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Rounds <code>x</code> to the nearest whole number (0.5 rounds up).

Method	T.C	S.C	Use
Math.log(x) / log10(x)	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Returns the natural logarithm (base e) or base-10 logarithm of x.
Integer.MAX_VALUE / MIN_VALUE	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	The largest/smallest value an int can hold: 2147483647 / -2147483648. Adding 1 past MAX_VALUE silently wraps to MIN_VALUE (overflow).
Long.MAX_VALUE / MIN_VALUE	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Like Integer's constants but for long, which has a much larger range — use when sums/products might exceed ~2.1 billion.
Integer.parseInt(str)	$O(n)$	$O(1)$	Converts a numeric String into an int. Throws NumberFormatException if str isn't a valid integer.
Integer.toBinaryString(x)	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Returns x's binary representation as a String (no leading zeros), e.g. 5 → "101".
Integer.bitCount(x)	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Returns how many bits are set to 1 in x (a.k.a. popcount).
Integer.numberOfTrailingZeros(x)	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Returns the position (0-indexed from the right) of the lowest set bit.
Integer.compare(a,b)	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Returns -1, 0, or 1 depending on whether $a < b$, $a == b$, or $a > b$ — safer than $a-b$, which can overflow for extreme values.

10. Character utilities

Method	T.C	S.C	Use
Character.isDigit(ch)	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Returns true if ch is a digit character ('0' through '9').
Character.isLetter(ch)	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Returns true if ch is an alphabetic letter.
Character.isLetterOrDigit(ch)	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Returns true if ch is either a letter or a digit.
Character.isUpperCase/isLowerCase(ch)	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Checks whether ch is uppercase or lowercase.
Character.toUpperCase/toLowerCase(ch)	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Returns the upper/lower-case version of ch.
Character.getNumericValue(ch)	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Converts a digit character to its int value, e.g. '7' → 7 (useful when parsing digits from a string one char at a time).

11. Collections utility class

Method	T.C	S.C	Use
<code>Collections.sort(list)</code> $O(n \log n)$	$O(n)$		Sort ascending
<code>Collections.reverse(list)</code> $O(n)$	$O(1)$		Reverse order
<code>Collections.shuffle(list)</code> $O(n)$	$O(1)$		Randomly reorders the list's elements in place (like shuffling a deck of cards).
<code>Collections.max/min(list)</code> $O(n)$	$O(1)$		Extremes
<code>Collections.swap(list,i,j)</code> $O(1)$	$O(1)$		Swaps the elements at positions i and j in place.
<code>Collections.unmodifiableList(list)</code> $O(1)$	$O(1)$		Returns a read-only wrapper around list — attempts to modify it throw <code>UnsupportedOperationException</code> . The underlying list can still change if modified through the original reference.
<code>Collections.nCopies(n,x)</code> $O(1)$	$O(1)$		Returns an immutable list containing x repeated n times, e.g. <code>nCopies(3, 0) → [0, 0, 0]</code> .

12. Fast I/O (critical for timed judges like TCS iON)

BufferedReader + StringTokenizer (fast, preferred for large input):

```
BufferedReader br = new BufferedReader(new InputStreamReader(System.in));
int n = Integer.parseInt(br.readLine().trim());
StringTokenizer st = new StringTokenizer(br.readLine());
int a = Integer.parseInt(st.nextToken());
int b = Integer.parseInt(st.nextToken());
```

💡 *Scanner is simpler but noticeably slower on large inputs — prefer BufferedReader under strict time limits.*

GCD / LCM (write manually):

```
static int gcd(int a, int b) { return b == 0 ? a : gcd(b, a % b); }
static int lcm(int a, int b) { return a / gcd(a, b) * b; }
```

💡 *Use long for sums/products that could exceed ~2.1 billion — int overflows silently.*

13. Bit Manipulation (operators, not methods)

Method	T.C	S.C	Use
<code>x & 1</code>	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Checks the lowest bit: result is 1 if x is odd, 0 if x is even.
<code>x >> 1</code>	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Shifts bits right by one position — equivalent to integer division by 2.
<code>x << 1</code>	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Shifts bits left by one position — equivalent to multiplying by 2.
<code>x >> n</code>	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Arithmetic (signed) right shift: divides by 2^n , rounding toward $-\infty$. Vacated high bits are filled with the SIGN bit, so a negative x stays negative.
<code>x >>> n</code>	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Logical (unsigned) right shift: vacated high bits are always filled with 0, regardless of sign. Use when treating x as an unsigned 32-bit value, e.g. <code>(x >>> 1)</code> for an overflow-safe midpoint average.
<code>x << n</code>	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Left shift by n multiplies by 2^n . Bits shifted past bit 31 (int) or bit 63 (long) are silently discarded — watch for overflow, e.g. <code>1 << 31</code> overflows int to <code>Integer.MIN_VALUE</code> .
<code>x & ~(1 << i)</code>	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Clears bit i to 0, leaving all other bits unchanged.
<code>x ^ (1 << i)</code>	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Flips (toggles) bit i: 0 becomes 1, 1 becomes 0.
<code>(x >> i) & 1</code>	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Checks whether bit i is set: returns 1 if set, 0 if not.
<code>x & -x</code>	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Isolates the lowest set bit of x, zeroing out all other bits (relies on two's-complement representation).
<code>x & y</code>	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	AND — result bit is 1 only when both bits are 1. Used to mask/isolate bits, e.g. <code>x & 0xFF</code> keeps only the lowest byte.
<code>x y</code>	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	OR — result bit is 1 if either bit is 1. Used to set/combine bits, e.g. <code>x (1 << i)</code> turns bit i on.
<code>x ^ y</code>	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	XOR — result bit is 1 when the two input bits differ, 0 when they match. Toggles bits, swaps two values without a temp variable, and finds the single non-duplicate element in an array (XOR everything together).
<code>~x</code>	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	NOT (bitwise complement) — flips every bit. In two's complement this equals $-(x+1)$, so <code>~5 == -6</code> and <code>~0 == -1</code> .
<code>~(x & y)</code>	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	NAND — Java has no direct operator; write it as <code>~(x & y)</code> . Result bit is 1 unless both input bits are 1.
<code>~(x y)</code>	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	NOR — Java has no direct operator; write it as <code>~(x y)</code> . Result bit is 1 only when both input bits are 0.

Method	T.C	S.C	Use
$\sim(x \wedge y)$	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	XNOR — Java has no direct operator; write it as $\sim(x \wedge y)$. Result bit is 1 when the two input bits are the same.

14. Number Base Conversions

Java built-ins for converting between decimal, binary, octal, and hexadecimal. Integer handles up to 32-bit values; use Long equivalents for larger numbers.

Method	T.C	S.C	Use
Integer.toString(n)	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Decimal int to binary String. $10 \rightarrow "1010"$. No leading zeros.
Integer.toOctalString(n)	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Decimal int to octal String. $8 \rightarrow "10"$.
Integer.toHexString(n)	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Decimal int to hex String (lowercase). $255 \rightarrow "ff"$.
Integer.parseInt(s, 2)	$O(n)$	$O(1)$	Binary String to decimal int. $"1010" \rightarrow 10$.
Integer.parseInt(s, 8)	$O(n)$	$O(1)$	Octal String to decimal int. $"17" \rightarrow 15$.
Integer.parseInt(s, 16)	$O(n)$	$O(1)$	Hex String to decimal int. $"ff" \rightarrow 255$.
Integer.toString(n, radix)	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Decimal to any base (2–36) as String. $\text{Integer.toString}(255, 16) \rightarrow "ff"$.
Long.toString(n)	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Same as Integer version but accepts long values (64-bit).
Long.parseLong(s, 2)	$O(n)$	$O(1)$	Binary String to long. Handles values $> \text{Integer.MAX_VALUE}$.
Integer.bitCount(n)	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Number of 1-bits in binary representation (popcount). $7 \rightarrow 3$.
Integer.highestOneBit(n)	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Returns value with only the highest set bit kept. $10 \rightarrow 8$.
Integer.reverse(n)	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Reverses all 32 bits of n.
Integer.reverseBytes(n)	$O(1)$	$O(1)$	Reverses the 4 bytes of n (byte-order swap).

Binary ↔ Decimal examples:

```
int dec = 42;
String bin = Integer.toBinaryString(dec); // "101010"
int back = Integer.parseInt(bin, 2);    // 42

// With leading zeros (padded to 8 bits)
String padded = String.format("%8s", bin).replace(' ', '0'); // "00101010"
```

All-bases conversion snippet:

```
int n = 255;
System.out.println(Integer.toBinaryString(n)); // 11111111
System.out.println(Integer.toOctalString(n)); // 377
System.out.println(Integer.toHexString(n)); // ff
System.out.println(Integer.toString(n, 36)); // 73 (base-36)
```

Parse any base back to decimal:

```
int fromBin = Integer.parseInt("11111111", 2); // 255
int fromOct = Integer.parseInt("377", 8); // 255
int fromHex = Integer.parseInt("ff", 16); // 255
```

💡 *Integer.parseInt(s, radix) throws NumberFormatException if the string contains digits invalid for that base — wrap in try-catch when parsing user input.*

💡 *Long.parseLong(s, 2) / Long.toBinaryString(n) mirror the Integer versions but accept 64-bit values — use when bit-mask values exceed ~2.1 billion.*

15. Quick decision table — which structure to use

Method	Use
Fast lookup by key	HashMap — $O(1)$ average get/put by key, no ordering guarantee.
Sorted keys, range queries	TreeMap — keeps keys sorted, supports floor/ceiling/range operations in $O(\log n)$.
Unique elements, fast membership	HashSet — $O(1)$ average contains(), no ordering guarantee.
Unique + sorted	TreeSet — like HashSet but keeps elements sorted, $O(\log n)$ operations.
LIFO (undo, parentheses, DFS)	Deque used as a Stack via push()/pop()/peek() — last in, first out.
FIFO (BFS, scheduling)	Deque used as a Queue via offer()/poll()/peek() — first in, first out.
Repeatedly get min/max	PriorityQueue — $O(\log n)$ insert/remove while always giving you the current min or max.
Index-based fast access	ArrayList / array — $O(1)$ get(index)/set(index) by position.
Insert/delete at both ends	ArrayDeque — $O(1)$ add/remove at both the front and back.